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One of the unexpected pleasures of the presidency has nothing to do with economic problems or international crises. It is the opportunity to lend a hand now and then to other human beings.

I was outraged one day in May 1982 when I read in the newspapers about a black family who lived near the University of Maryland. The husband and wife were both employed in a government printing office. They had been harassed and a cross had been burned on their lawn.

I asked our staff to clear my late afternoon schedule. I called Nancy, and she was happy to join me in visiting these victims of intolerance. They were a nice couple with a four-year-old daughter and a grandma, a most gracious lady, living with them. Their home was comfortable and tastefully furnished. We enjoyed our visit and when it was time to leave they saw us to our car. Our motorcade had naturally been noticed, so there was quite a turnout of people from the neighborhood, and our farewells at curbside were warmly applauded by the neighbors. Needless to say, this fine family had no further harassment.

Another time, I read a story in *The New York Times* about a twenty-nine-year-old father of eight who had been out of work for thirteen months during the depths of the recession. He was returning home after applying for a job when an elderly blind man broke his cane and fell to the tracks of the subway. The young man bravely jumped down onto the tracks and rescued him. We found out his telephone number and I called him. I asked if he had gotten the job he had applied for before the incident; he said he was just leaving his home to go back for a second interview. I called the